

Replication Package Read-me

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1 Project Title

Replication Package for:

“The Effect of Age at Graduation on Family Formation: Evidence from the Bologna Process”

Software: Stata 18

2 Package Structure

Replication_package/

README.pdf

run.do

code/

configuration/

configuration.do

import_append/

01_import_and_append_lfs.do

processed/

02_build_analysis_dataset.do

descriptives/

03_descriptives_stats.do

Data/

raw_data/

processed/

output/

```
descriptives_table/
```

3 Data Description

Data used in the analysis come from the publicly available Italian Labour Force Survey (LFS) provided by the Italian National Institute of Statistics (ISTAT). The analysis uses quarterly survey waves from 2009 to 2020.

The original raw datasets are proprietary ISTAT microdata and are distributed in TXT format.

Raw data files are stored in:

```
Replication_package/Data/raw_data/
```

Processed datasets generated by the replication code are stored in:

```
Replication_package/Data/processed/
```

The file:

```
lfs_istat_2009_2020_appended.dta
```

contains all quarterly waves appended together after conversion from TXT format to Stata DTA format.

4 Computational requirements

The replication package was developed using Stata 18. The runtime requires approximately 20 minutes for the whole code, including the full reconstruction of the appended dataset from the raw TXT files, while less time for the replication, using the provided appended Stata dataset.

5 Instructions to Replicate

Before running the replication package, open Stata and set the working directory to the root folder of the replication package:

```
cd "path/to/Replication_package"
```

Then run:

```
do run.do
```

By default, the code uses the provided appended Stata dataset stored in:

```
Data/processed/
```

To rebuild the appended dataset from the original raw TXT files, open `run.do` and set:

```
global rebuild_from_raw 1
```

The default option is:

```
global rebuild_from_raw 0
```

which skips the TXT import and append step.

6 Code Organization

The code is organized as follows:

- `run.do`: master script that runs the full replication workflow.
- `code/configuration/configuration.do`: defines project paths, folders, and general Stata settings.
- `code/import_append/01_import_and_append_lfs.do`: imports the original ISTAT Labour Force Survey TXT files, converts them to Stata format, and creates the appended dataset.
- `code/processed/02_build_analysis_dataset.do`: constructs the main variables, defines the analytical sample, and saves the final analysis dataset. To avoid repeated observations of the same household, only first-wave interviews (`wavqua == 1`) are retained. The Italian Labour Force Survey follows households across multiple interviews over time. Since the version of the survey used in this project does not allow the researcher to distinguish original households from replacement households, restricting the sample to first-wave interviews prevents duplicate observations of the same household.
- `code/descriptives/03_descriptives_stats.do`: produces the descriptive statistics table.

7 Output Mapping

The replication package produces the following outputs:

- `descriptive_statistics.tex`
Descriptive statistics table produced by `03_descriptives_stats.do`.
stored in:

`output/descriptives_table`